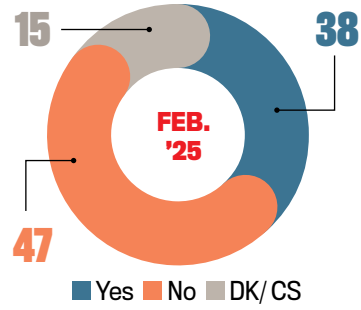
the rumblings among INDIA partners about the Congress leading the alliance, a majority believe that the Grand Old Party is the real Opposition party to challenge the BJP. Rahul Gandhi continues to be the best suited to lead the Opposition though the support has dropped by eight percentage points compared to the August 2024 MOTN. Despite the clamour for the West Bengal chief minister to lead INDIA, she is rated far below Rahul in this role, as are Arvind Kejriwal and Akhilesh Yadav. Rahul's rating as a leader of the Opposition continues to be high, with 49 per cent endorsing it as good or outstanding. Rahul is also seen as the best to lead the Congress at a high 36.4 per cent, with Priyanka coming second, followed by Sachin Pilot and Mallikarjun Kharge.

When it comes to leadership in the BJP, Modi's ratings remain stratospheric, and Amit Shah still leads over Yogi Adityanath as the best suited to succeed the prime minister. Both are well ahead of the others, namely Nitin Gadkari, Rajnath Singh and Shivraj Singh Chouhan. Yogi Adityanath emerges as the most popular chief minister in the country, though MOTN findings show that he needs to improve his personal ratings in his home state.

Overall, the MOTN reflects an impressive comeback for Modi and the BJP after the jolt in the general election. It gives them a full mandate to execute bold reforms and ensure speedy economic growth while ensuring internal security and communal harmony. As Nelson Mandela once remarked, "The greatest glory in living lies not in never failing, but in rising every time we fall." ■

Q. Do you agree with the BJP's allegation about the Congress taking funds from George Soros for anti-India activities?



Most respondents reject the BJP's allegation about a Congress-Soros nexus

Methodology

The India Today Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll was conducted by CVoter, a globally renowned name in the field of socio-economic research, between January 2, 2025, and February 9, 2025, interviewing 54,418 respondents covering all Lok Sabha segments across all states. In addition to these samples, 70,705 interviews from CVoter's regular tracker data over the past 24 weeks were also analysed for the long-term trendline projections of votes and seats. Thus, the opinion of a total of 125,123 respondents was considered for this MOTN report. The margin of error is +/- 3 per cent at macro level and +/- 5 per cent at the micro level of reporting with 95 per cent confidence level.

From May 2009 onwards, the CVoter Tracker has been carried out each week, 52 waves in a calendar year, in 11 national languages, across all states and UTs in India, with a target sample size of 60,000 samples each quarter. The average response rate is 55 per cent. Starting January 1, 2019, CVoter has been carrying the tracker on a daily basis, using the rollover sample of seven days for tracker analysis.

All these polls are based on a random probability sample as used in the globally standardised methodology, carried out by trained researchers across all geographic and demographic segments. This survey is based on Computer Assisted Telephone Interviews (CATI) of adult respondents across all segments. Standard Random Digit Dialing (RDD) is used to draw random numbers covering all frequency series allocated to all operators across all telecom circles in India.

CVoter ensures proper representative analysis by statistical weighing of the data to make it representative of the local population as per the latest census figures. The data is weighted to the known census profile, including gender, age, education, income, religion, caste, urban/rural and vote recalls for the past Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. For the analytics, CVoter uses its proprietary algorithm to calculate the provincial and regional vote share based on the split-voter phenomenon.

CVoter follows the code of professional ethics and practices drafted by the World Association of Public Opinion Research and the official guidelines on opinion polling as instructed by the Press Council of India. ■